



Medal rush: Sweden's Mondo Duplantis set a pole vault world record at 6.30m, while USA's Melissa Jefferson-Wooden claimed a sprint treble in Tokyo. AFP

Kushare and Pooja Olla in the 800m) set Personal Bests. The men's 4x400m relay team, which had set the Asian record and finished fifth in Budapest, did not even qualify for Tokyo. Other disappointments included double Asian champion Gulveer Singh, who finished 16th in the men's 10,000m and missed out on a 5,000m final spot by one place. In the women's 3,000m steeplechase, national-record holder and Asian silver medallist Parul Chaudhary ended 20th overall, failing to make

the final. Triple jumper Praveen Chithravel, who had resgitered a national record-equalling 17.37m earlier in the season, managed only 16.74m in Tokyo.

Still, there were bright spots. High jumper Kushare cleared a Personal Best of 2.28m to finish sixth – the best ever result for an Indian high jumper at a global event. It was all the more remarkable given he was the shortest athlete in the elite final and had competed internationally only once this year, at the Asian

Championships. Meanwhile, Pooja may not have advanced past her 800m heat, but her 2:01.03 clocking made her the seventh-fastest Indian ever in the event, marking her as a promising prospect for 2026.

Mondo, McLaughlin stand out

If India's results disappointed, the Championships still delivered a slew of headline performances in the first Worlds of the 2028 Olympic cycle.

One World Record, nine Championships Records and nine